FINAL HONOUR SCHOOL OF
PHILOSOPHY, POLITICS AND ECONOMICS (PPE):
INTERNAL EXAMINERS' REPORT
2018

This report is was updated on 13 February 2020 to correct statistics in Part A, 1-2 and 5. It includes three sections: Part A – Statistics; Part B – Chair's Comments; Part C – Comments on Individual Papers (Politics only).

PART A: Statistics

1. Class distribution of FHS candidates

Class	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012
1st	**39** **17%**	54 22.7%	38 16.4%	55 22.1%	51 20.6%	70 29.3%	47 19.3%
2.1	**178** **77.7%**	170 71.4%	179 77.2%	183 73.5%	188 76.1%	153 64.0%	188 77.0%
2.2	**12** **5.2%**	12 5.0%	15 6.5%	11 4.4%	6 2.4%	16 6.7%	9 3.7%
3rd		2 0.8%			2 0.8%		
Honours Pass							
Fail							
Total	**229**	**238**	**232**	**249**	**247**	**239**	**244**

2. Statistics by Gender and Ethnicity

a. Class Distributions by Gender (%)

Class	2018		2017		2016		2015		2014		2013	
	F	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**
1st	**16.5**	**17.3**	18.4	24.7	14.5	17.4	10.6	28.0	17.1	22.4	27.6	30.1
2.1	**82.3**	**75.3**	72.4	71.0	80.7	75.2	85.9	67.1	82.9	72.7	67.1	62.6
2.2	**1.3**	**7.3**	7.9	3.7	4.8	7.4	3.5	4.9		3.6	5.3	7.4
3rd			1.3	0.6						1.2		
Pass												
Fail												

b. Overall Statistics by Gender

	2018		2017		2016		2015	
	F	M	F	M	F	M	F	M
Total Candidates	79 34.5%	151 65.5%	76 31.9%	162 68.1%	82 34.9%	150 65.1%	84 33.7%	165 66.3%
Average Mark	64.9	64.6	64.3	65.2	65.1	65.5	64.5	65.6
Standard Deviation	5.2	6.5	6.9	6.8	5.5	6.3	5.5	6.3

c. Class Distributions by Ethnicity

	2014/15*			2013/14			2012/13		
	White	BME	Unknown	White	BME	Unknown	White	BME	Unknown
1st	41 24%	9 19%	1 9%	35 21%	9 14%		38 21%	9 17%	1 5%
2.1	122 72%	34 72%	10 91%	126 74%	51 78%	2 100%	132 73%	39 74%	17 85%
2.2	6 4%	3 6%		8 5%	5 8%		10 5%	5 9%	2 10%
3rd		1 2%		1 1%					
Total	169	47	11	170	65	2	182	53	20

(Source = Annual Programme Statistics, Departmental Report)

*most recent year available when the report was published. The year refers to the year in which students commenced study, not the year in which the exams were taken.

3. Statistics by Paper

'Code' in the table below refers to each paper's number in the Examination Regulations; each paper's name and number are listed in section 4 below. Where different papers share a code, the initials of the paper name are given in brackets. No statistics are given for papers taken by 2 candidates or fewer. Only the mean and standard deviation are given for papers taken by 5 candidates or fewer.

Code	Candidates	>=70	>=60	>=50	>=40	<=30	<30	Q1	Median	Q3	Mean	St. Dev.
101	34	12%	85%	3%				67.0	65.0	64.0	65.6	3.1
102	60	10%	62%	25%	3%			66.3	64.0	59.0	62.7	5.7
103	134	19%	66%	14%			1%	69.0	65.5	61.3	65.2	7.6
104	10	20%	30%	50%				69.0	62.5	55.8	62.9	6.8
106	3										60.7	3.3
107	25	4%	96%					67.0	66.0	64.0	65.8	2.1
108	10	50%	50%					70.8	68.5	66.0	68.6	3.6
109	12	8%	75%	17%				68.0	66.0	62.5	65.1	4.2
112	5										65.6	3.4

113	9	11%	89%					68.0	67.0	67.0	67.6	2.1
114	28	14%	71%	11%	4%			68.0	66.0	64.0	65.4	4.7
115	36	19%	78%	3%				68.0	65.5	63.0	65.8	3.9
116	13	31%	62%	8%				70.0	68.0	64.0	66.6	4.3
117	1											
118	6	33%	67%					69.0	65.5	65.0	66.7	2.9
120	1											
122	0											
124	2											
125	4										67.8	2.9
127	17	12%	76%	12%				68.0	65.0	63.0	65.1	4.2
128	28	14%	57%	29%				65.3	62.0	58.8	63.0	5.8
129	34	12%	85%	3%				67.0	65.0	64.0	65.6	3.1
150	6		100%					66.8	65.0	63.3	65.2	2.0
198 (FoEA)	4										68.8	3.5
198 (PoA)	2											
199	6	83%	17%					76.5	72.0	70.5	73.3	4.7
201	58	21%	72%	7%				68.0	66.0	63.3	66.0	4.4
202	69	28%	58%	14%				70.0	66.0	62.0	66.1	6.4
203	85	24%	64%	13%				69.0	65.0	62.0	65.4	4.7
204	11	18%	82%					68.0	67.0	62.5	65.5	3.5
205	17	29%	59%	12%				70.0	67.0	64.0	66.6	4.9
208	23	35%	65%					71.5	68.0	66.5	68.9	4.5
209	7	29%	57%		14%			70.5	65.0	62.0	64.4	7.9
210	6	17%	67%	17%				66.8	66.0	65.3	65.5	5.6
211	31	10%	87%	3%				67.0	65.0	63.5	65.0	3.2
212	17	29%	71%					70.0	65.0	64.0	66.6	4.2
213	24	21%	79%					69.0	66.0	63.8	66.1	3.5
214	127	17%	76%	7%				68.0	65.0	62.0	65.4	4.4
215	14	14%	79%	7%				68.0	67.5	63.5	66.1	3.5
216	10	30%	60%	10%				69.5	67.5	65.5	67.1	4.4
217	8	50%	50%					72.8	69.5	66.8	70.4	6.9
218	3										67.0	5.7
220	67	18%	70%	12%				68.0	65.0	62.5	65.1	4.4
223	5										67.8	3.0
224	23	17%	74%	9%				68.0	66.0	63.0	65.6	4.1
225	3										73.3	3.1
227	15	47%	53%					70.0	69.0	67.0	69.1	4.1
228	9	33%	67%					70.0	67.0	65.0	67.1	2.9
229	26	31%	58%	12%				70.8	66.5	63.0	66.9	5.7
236	5										67.2	6.1
237	12	25%	75%					68.8	67.0	65.3	67.1	3.5
239	12	17%	75%	8%				68.3	66.5	65.8	66.3	4.1

297 (CPE)	18	39%	61%					72.8	68.0	64.3	68.4	4.6
297 (ISC)	37	49%	49%	3%				70.0	69.0	66.0	68.3	3.3
298	0											
299	16	38%	50%	13%				71.0	67.5	65.0	67.2	4.2
300	144	25%	42%	24%	6%	3%		69.3	63.5	56.8	62.1	10.0
301	156	18%	59%	22%	1%			67.0	63.5	60.0	63.4	5.6
302	154	14%	60%	23%	3%			66.0	62.0	59.0	62.3	6.1
303	19	26%	37%	16%	16%	5%		68.5	63.0	53.5	61.2	11.7
304	13	23%	77%					69.0	66.0	64.0	66.5	3.6
305	20	20%	75%	5%				67.0	65.0	62.0	64.9	3.4
306	19	21%	47%	32%				68.0	66.0	58.5	64.1	6.8
307 (222)	4										64.0	2.7
308	9	22%	78%					69.0	65.0	64.0	65.9	3.3
310	18	22%	72%	6%				68.0	65.0	63.3	65.4	3.6
311	12	25%	75%					66.3	64.0	63.8	65.5	3.4
314	20	35%	35%	15%	10%	5%		70.8	64.0	57.8	63.4	13.3
319	14	50%	29%	21%				71.8	67.5	61.0	66.4	9.1
320	11	9%	91%					66.5	63.0	62.5	64.5	2.9
321 (126)	1											
374	7		100%					65.0	64.0	62.5	63.7	2.1
399	0											

4. Numbers Offering Each Paper

The number of distinct papers (including supervised dissertations and theses) offered in the 2018 Final Honour School of PPE was 76.

a. Philosophy

Philosophy	**2018**	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**
101. Early Modern Philosophy	**34**	43	38	49	50	44	63
102. Knowledge and Reality	**60**	64	77	75	60	55	38
103. Ethics	**134**	151	145	154	158	152	155
104. Philosophy of Mind	**10**	6	20	14	21	18	14
106. Philosophy of Sci. and Soc. Sci.	**3**	9	7	1	8	3	6
107. Philosophy of Religion	**25**	25	26	38	46	32	32
108. Philosophy of Logic and Lang.	**10**	9	15	18	10	18	12
109. Aesthetics	**12**	26	26	17	15	15	22
110. Medieval Philosophy: Aquinas	**0**	1	0	2	2	3	1
112. The Philosophy of Kant	**5**	4	8	5	8	7	6
113. Post-Kantian Philosophy	**9**	24	11	22	25	21	19
114. Theory of Politics (203)	**28**	37	31	34	37	38	38
115. Plato: Republic	**36**	39	38	39	40	39	56
116. Aristotle: Nicomachean Ethics	**13**	24	9	28	20	19	30
117. Frege, Russell, and Wittgenstein	**1**	3	0	2	0	2	1

118. The Later Philosophy of Witt.	**6**	15	11	9	9	10	16
119. Set Theory, Logic	**0**	1	1	0	N/A	N/A	N/A
120. Intermed. Phil. of Physics	**1**	0	0	0	0	0	0
122. Philosophy of Mathematics	**0**	2	2	1	0	0	0
124. Philosophy of Science	**2**	5	1	4	2	5	2
125. Philosophy of Cognitive Science	**4**	0	5	4	4	2	1
127. Philosophical Logic	**17**	13	13	5	N/A	N/A	N/A
128. Practical Ethics	**28**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
150. Jurisprudence	**6**	8	9	6	5	7	7
198. Special Subject (FoEA)	**4**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
198. Special Subject (PoA)	**2**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
199. Thesis	**6**	12	10	9	8	8	4

b. Politics

Politics (PPE)	**2018**	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**
201. Comparative Government	**58**	51	64	67	88	69	78
202. BPG since 1900	**69**	72	60	67	57	48	47
203. Theory of Politics (114)	**85**	93	95	98	108	114	109
204. Modern British Gov. and Pol.	**11**	18	24	15	18	18	14
205. Gov. and Pol. of the US	**17**	23	20	17	27	24	24
206. Politics in Europe	**5**	5	5	7	10	15	15
207. Pol. in Russia and the Fmr USSR	**12**	9	5	12	11	9	6
208. Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa	**23**	22	28	24	36	34	42
209. Politics in Latin America	**7**	6	9	11	9	11	14
210. Politics in South Asia	**6**	9	7	9	12	9	13
211. Politics in the Middle East	**31**	32	35	32	38	31	38
212. IR in the Era of Two World Wars	**17**	8	3	16	15	14	19
213. IR in the Era of the Cold War	**24**	30	25	23	32	34	34
214. International Relations	**127**	120	115	135	135	124	143
215. Pol. Thought: Plato to Rousseau	**14**	22	19	22	20	18	29
216. Pol. Thought: Benth. to Weber	**10**	20	16	17	22	23	29
217. Marx and Marxism	**8**	20	9	15	14	18	15
218. Sociological Theory	**3**	13	21	10	24	14	21
219. The Soc. of Post-Indust. Soc.	**12**	4	17	7	3	2	N/A
220. Political Sociology	**67**	62	76	61	58	61	71
223. The Gov. and Politics of Japan	**5**	4	0	3	2	0	1
224. Social Policy	**23**	16	28	33	27	16	14
225. CDS (pre-2016 see 315)	**3**	3	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
226. Quant. Meth. in Pol. and Soc.	**N/A**	1	5	6	3	2	4
227. Politics in China	**15**	14	18	13	20	23	24
228. The Politics of the EU	**9**	4	2	11	8	10	8
229. Adv. Paper in Theories of Just.	**26**	16	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Comp. Pol. Economy	**18**	10	19	21	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Int. Secu. and Conflict	**37**	18	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
298. Supervised dissertation	**0**	9	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
299. Thesis	**16**	21	23	15	24	18	30

Politics (History and Politics)	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012
201. Comparative Government	**8**	7	5	13	16	10	7
202. BPG since 1900	**15**	16	12	14	16	16	12
203. Theory of Politics (114)	**21**	19	26	15	19	20	23
204. Modern British Gov. and Pol.	**2**	1	5	3	5	5	2
205. Gov. and Pol. of the US	**3**	1	5	4	5	5	3
206. Politics in Europe	**1**	2	1	2	1	2	0
207. Pol. in Russia and the Fmr USSR	**2**	1	3	3	2	1	0
208. Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa	**6**	5	5	5	4	2	4
209. Politics in Latin America	**1**	1	2	0	1	2	0
210. Politics in South Asia	**1**	0	3	0	1	3	5
211. Politics in the Middle East	**5**	8	9	8	9	12	9
212. IR in the Era of Two World Wars	**2**	2	2	5	1	3	1
213. IR in the Era of the Cold War	**3**	3	9	6	6	7	4
214. International Relations	**19**	25	35	26	30	29	24
215. Pol. Thought: Plato to Rousseau	**1**	2	5	4	2	2	4
216. Pol. Thought: Benth. to Weber	**2**	3	2	2	10	3	5
217. Marx and Marxism	**3**	3	3	1	3	4	4
218. Sociological Theory	**0**	1	2	2	0	4	1
219. The Soc. of Post-Indust. Soc.	**1**	1	1	1	2	1	N/A
220. Political Sociology	**9**	9	16	12	12	18	12
223. The Gov. and Politics of Japan	**1**	0	1	0	1	0	0
224. Social Policy	**1**	5	5	3	5	3	2
225. CDS (pre-2016 see 315)	**1**	0	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
226. Quant. Meth. in Pol. and Soc.	**N/A**	0	0	0	1	1	0
227. Politics in China	**1**	5	2	1	3	4	3
228. The Politics of the EU	**3**	1	2	1	2	4	1
229. Adv. Paper in Theories of Just.	**2**	2	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Comp. Pol. Economy	**0**	1	1	0	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Int. Secu. and Conflict	**6**	4	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
298. Supervised dissertation	**N/A**	1	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
299. Thesis	**7**	11	11	8	9	7	13

c. Economics

Economics	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012
300. Quantitative Economics	**144**	143	138	150	141	144	151
301. Macroeconomics	**156**	152	144	156	146	150	151
302. Microeconomics	**154**	154	146	157	146	150	151
303. Microeconomic Theory	**N/A**	1	12	11	15	25	28
303. Microeconomic Analysis	**19**	11	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
304. Money & Banking	**13**	15	11	10	12	12	19
305. Public Economics	**20**	20	16	21	25	17	37
306. Economics of Industry	**19**	19	11	15	8	8	17
307. Labour Econ. and Ind. Rel. (222)	**4**	13	7	13	13	13	14
308. International Economics	**9**	6	4	11	8	8	20

310. Economics of Devel. Countries	**18**	34	29	23	27	32	32
311. British Econ. History since 1870	**12**	7	8	7	6	6	18
314. Econometrics	**20**	18	13	32	27	21	23
318. Finance	**7**	9	N/A	N/A	0	1	15
319. Game Theory	**14**	13	12	25	23	30	37
320. Behavioural and Exper. Econ.	**11**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
320. Mathematical Methods	**N/A**	5	31	33	11	17	16
321. Phil. & Econ. of the Envir. (126)	**1**	8	9	16	7	7	N/A
399. Thesis	**0**	0	2	2	0	1	0

5. Statistics by Branch

For joint papers, two paper codes exist to distinguish candidates taking the paper under one branch from candidates taking the paper under the other. Scripts were allocated to the relevant branch accordingly. The three separate assessments for Jurisprudence candidates are counted as one Philosophy script. Set Theory and Logic are counted as one Philosophy script. 'Subjects' in the next two tables comprise scripts, theses, and supervised dissertations.

a. Approximate percentages of subjects in each branch:

	2018	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**
Philosophy	**24.9**	27.6	27.6	32.3	30.2	31.2	31.8
Politics	**41.5**	40.1	40.6	41.1	41.2	39.1	40.9
Economics	**33.7**	32.4	31.8	26.5	28.6	29.7	27.3

b. Average mark and standard deviation for subjects in each branch:

	2018	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**
All Subjects (Avg)	**64.9**	65.0	65.4	65.2	65.3
All Subjects (St Dev)	**6.1**	6.8	6.1	6.1	6.1
Total	**1835**	1901	1854		
Philosophy (Avg)	**65.1**	65.1	65.8	65.6	64.9
Philosophy (St Dev)	**4.9**	5.0	5.2	5.1	5.1
Total	**456**	524	512		
Politics (Avg)	**66.2**	65.7	65.8	65.5	65.8
Politics (St Dev)	**4.8**	5.9	5.0	5.3	5.1
Total	**761**	761	756		
Economics (Avg)	**63.1**	64.1	64.6	64.5	64.8
Economics (St Dev)	**7.6**	8.8	7.7	7.5	8.3
Total	**618**	616	586		

c. Classifications broken down by routes through PPE:

2018

Class	Phil-Ec	Pol-Ec	Phil-Pol	Phil-Pol-Ec
1st **% of cand. in this route**	5 13.2%	17 17.5%	15 20.8%	2 9.1%
2.1	28 73.7%	73 75.3%	57 79.2%	20 90.9%
2.2	5 13.2%	7 7.2%		
3rd				
Total **% of all candidates**	38 16.6%	97 42.4%	72 31.4%	22 9.6%

2017

Class	Phil-Ec	Pol-Ec	Phil-Pol	Phil-Pol-Ec
1st	12 25.5%	19 20.9%	22 26.2%	1 6.3%
2.1	29 61.7%	67 73.6%	60 71.4%	14 87.5%
2.2	6 12.8%	3 3.3%	2 2.4%	1 6.3%
3rd	0	2 2.2%	0	0
Total	47 19.7%	91 38.2%	84 35.3%	16 6.7%

2016

Class	Phil-Ec	Pol-Ec	Phil-Pol	Phil-Pol-Ec
1st	7 16.7%	15 16.7%	15 17.4%	1 7.1%
2.1	31 73.8%	69 76.7%	67 77.9%	12 85.7%
2.2	4 9.5%	6 6.7%	4 4.7%	1 7.1%
Total	42 18.1%	90 38.8%	86 37.1%	14 6.0%

6. Applications for Consideration of Factors Affecting Performance

See Part B: Chair's Comments, section 4.

7. Supervised Dissertation and Thesis Titles

Theses in Philosophy (6)

- Causation, Harm, and the Non-Identity Problem
- Is There More Than One Way of Being?
- Human Nature and Emotional Freedom: Spinoza's Critique of the Cartesian Theory of the Passions
- The Dignity of the Human Life-Form: a Neo-Aristotelian Naturalist Theory of Moral Status
- Repeated Wrongdoing and Forgiveness over Time

- The New Riddle of Induction and the Role of Psychological Maxims

Theses in Politics (16):

- What impact has the rise of the Bharatiya Janata Party had on Muslim Women in India?
- Violence, Probability, and Threat Perception: Unpacking the Effect of Violence on Levels of Civilian Displacement
- Do Effects of International Economic Sanctions Vary among Authoritarian Regimes?
- The Role of Religion in the Work of Robert Owen
- The Changing Nature of Hegemony Since the Fall of the Soviet Union: A Neo-Gramscian Perspective
- What Determines Variation in the Shape of Police Reform in Latin America? A Comparative Analysis of Brazil and El Salvador
- Scaling Up the Deliberative Ideal: Mini-publics and Contentious Politics
- Marriage and Gender Politics in the Care Economy
- The Joint US-Russian Effort to Dismantle Syrian Chemical Weapons
- Things Hold Together: Federal and Consociational Policies on Ethnic Conflict in Nigeria
- Differentiating between the Mechanisms Linking Oil Endowments to Civil Conflict
- Women and Slavery: Finding a Theory of Justice that Can Account for the Experiences of Victims of Human Trafficking in Today's World
- A Study of The Evolution of The Chinese Judiciary Through a Comparison of Two Criminal Law Cases
- The Rise before the Fall: Developments in Consensus Politics in Britain since 1979
- The Working-Class Homophobe: A Study of Homosexuality in a British Class Context
- Mainstream Party Responses to Eurosceptic Challenger Parties

(The 7 Politics theses submitted in FHS History & Politics were:

- *Islamic Extremism, Education, and State-Ulama Relations: Exploring the Relationship between Education and Extremism in 22 Muslim Majority Countries*
- *Justice in Black and White: A Critical Theory of Race in relation to Global Justice*
- *Women Who Consent to Female Genital Mutilation / Cutting in Euro-American States: A Clash of Bio-Ethics, Multiculturalism, and Feminism*
- *Does Offensive Realism Explain Russia's More Assertive Foreign Policy towards its Neighbours?*
- *How far were the Social Policy Reforms of the Liberal Party Motivated by Degeneration Theories between 1906-14?*
- *Why did the Kyoto Protocol Fail to Reduce Global Emissions from 1990 Levels between 2008-12?*
- *Generation Me: How do Young Labour Party Supporters Rationalise their Vote in the 2017 British General Election?)*

Theses in Economics (0)

PART B: Chair's Comments

1. Personnel
(a) Internal Examiners

There were 11 internal examiners.

Philosophy	Guy Kahane, Jeff McMahan, Cecilia Trifogli (Convenor),
Politics	Michael Hart, Edward Keene (Chair of Examiners), Tim Power, Stuart White (Convenor), Stephen Whitefield,
Economics	Alan Beggs, Chris Bowdler (Convenor), Godfrey Keller (Chair of Subject Board).

(b) External Examiners

Philosophy	Mike Otsuka (London School of Economics),
Politics	Stephen Hopgood (School of Oriental and African Studies),
Economics	Gianni de Fraja (University of Nottingham).

The External Examiners reviewed and commented on draft question papers at the paper-setting stage; they read a selection of scripts from different classes; they attended the First Examiners' Meeting on the afternoon of Tuesday 3 July 2018 and the Final Examiners' Meeting on Thursday 5 July 2018.

2. Marking Conventions
The scale of marks used and the classification conventions were the same as in the previous year. The following changes were made to the Examination Conventions this year:

- Links to the Economics Subject Board Conventions were introduced.
- Information on how the final result is calculated was introduced for two new Philosophy papers, 'Philosophy of Action' and 'Foundations of Effective Altruism', which are each assessed by two essays.
- Information on submission requirements was introduced for the new Economics paper, 'Behavioural and Experimental Economics'.
- Thesis marking descriptors for Politics theses were added.
- The penalty for late submission 'more than 14 days after the notice of non-submission' was changed to 'fail'.
- The penalty for non-attendance at an examination was added.
- Rules on resits were added.

3. Problems with Exam Papers
For one paper, one minor correction was made just before or during the exam:

i. A12705W1: Plato: Republic
On page 4, 'book 10' (the reference for a quotation) was changed to 'book 8'.

4. General Issues

i. Subject Boards
As noted in previous reports, Economics has now adopted a Subject Board and Philosophy effectively has made a similar move. This appeared to work well in terms of the overall efficiency of the PPE Board, although the Board will need to continue to ensure consistent marking across the three subject elements of the degree. As the statistics above show, the

average mark in Economics papers has typically been slightly lower than average marks in Philosophy or Politics papers, but that gap widened this year; all of the 12 candidates to be classified as Lower Second Class degrees had studied Economics as one of their subjects (5 were Phil/Econ and 7 Pol/Econ). Politics may well adopt a Subject Board in turn, and used an informal pre-PPE Board meeting this year as a step in that direction.

ii. Factors Affecting Performance

There were 31 applications for consideration of Factors Affecting Performance, down from over 40 last year. 12 were due to 'acute illness during an examination', 4 due to 'other urgent cause during an examination', 5 due to 'other' reasons, and 9 due to multiple reasons (e.g. a combination of 'acute illness' and 'other'). In 23 cases no action was taken. In 6 cases the classification was raised (or otherwise altered in the candidate's favour). In 1 case a paper was disregarded.

iii. Subject Access Requests

As noted in this report last year, Subject Access Requests (requests for information, such as question-level marks or examiners' comments, by individual students after results have been released) continue to create a very large amount of administrative work. The information requested is held in separate spreadsheets submitted by the different markers, which means that to complete one Subject Access Request, the exam board administrator has to retrieve, copy, and paste data from 16 or more different spreadsheets. This would not be doable in the time allowed if a larger fraction of the cohort submitted Subject Access Requests. It would be helpful if the University could develop a system capable of holding all examining information for each candidate, so that these requests can be dealt with quickly and easily.

PART C: Internal Examiners' Comments

a. Philosophy
See separate report covering all Philosophy Honour Schools.

The Gibbs Prize for the best performance in the Philosophy papers in PPE FHS was awarded to:
Daniel Kodsi, Balliol

For details of any other Philosophy prizes won by PPE students, refer to the Philosophy report.

b. Economics
See separate report covering all Economics Honour Schools.

c. Politics

TOP PERFORMANCES AND PRIZES
Gibbs Prizes for the best Politics written papers in the Final Honour Schools of PPE and History and Politics:

1st – Syed Tirmizi, Oriel (PPE)
2nd – Nicholas Halterman, Balliol (PPE)

Proxime Accessit:
Edward Ray, Mansfield (PPE)
Dylan Spielman, Exeter (PPE)

Gibbs Prize for the best Politics thesis or supervised dissertation in the Final Honour Schools of PPE and History and Politics:
Joshua Byrne, Magdalen (HP)

REPORTS ON INDIVIDUAL PAPERS (PPE and HP)

201: Comparative Government
There were 66 candidates (58 PPE, 8 HP).

No questions were reported during the exam and the overall quality of answers was good, with most answers citing most of the relevant key readings. The average grade across all scripts was 66.1, the standard deviation 4.4.

The most popular questions were numbers 8 (colonialism/democracy, thus covering two topics), 4 (electoral systems and party competition), 2 (hybrid regimes). The least chosen questions were 1 (methods), 6 (interest groups), 11 (democracy's impact on welfare), 12 (constitutions). The unweighted average score across all questions was similar. All questions received at least one answer.

I now turn to general impressions from examiners on key questions.

Question 2: The complete answer would begin with defining competitive authoritarianism and considering the role of international links and strong party organization (the distinction between party-driven regimes versus top-down military regimes). Way/Levitsky, Ansell/Samuels, and Svolik

needed to be discussed. Weak answers repeated readings from just the topic of democratization, without engaging nuances of authoritarian classifications.
Question 3: Strong answers defined what constituted a challenge to a right-left cleavage and how one measures economic integration and the cleavage. Theoretical reasons as to why globalization would matter for a cleavage needed to be considered. Specific OECD examples were needed. Good answers also had more precise data on globalization and consideration of contemporary evidence.
Question 4: The best answers considered not just the relationship between these institutions, but also alternative explanations for electoral systems. Consideration of both historical and contemporary examples was important.
Question 8a: This question needed to have an answer discussing the role of colonial institutions, referring to work by Acemoglu/Robinson and their critics; many of the readings on contemporary outcomes today should have been cited.

202: British Politics and Government since 1900
There were 84 candidates; 69 in PPE and 15 in MHP

Question 1. To what extent was New Liberalism a response to electoral challenges? (51 answers)
This was the most answered question. Nearly all answers showed knowledge of Liberal legislation before 1914, and most knew something about New Liberalism and its origins. Some candidates had difficulty explaining the link between the two while others made the simple and unconvincing claim that New Liberalism was simply 'what the Liberals did'. The electoral challenges were too often interpreted as only the young Labour Party, with most concluding that Labour was not (yet) a challenge to the Liberals. A surprising number of essays ignored the Conservatives altogether, although a few knew enough about the free trade/tariff reform controversy to consider why that might have been a challenge to economic orthodoxy. A further strand of argument was that the Labour party was more interested in industrial and trade union questions than state sponsored social reform and therefore if there was an electoral challenge it arose from class-based changes well removed from New Liberalism. Finally, a few essays concentrated on New Liberalism as a more-or-less coherent theory and claimed that it challenged the Liberal Party and its assumptions as much as anything else. A large number of essays demonstrated wide reading and a recognition of the several different ways in which the question could be approached. The best answers were sophisticated and thoughtful.

Question 2. Why did the Labour Party fail to win a parliamentary majority before 1945? (7 answers)
The question covered a long period and allowed candidates to concentrate on what they chose. The essays covered Labour's opportunities and whether it made the most of them, how the emergence of policy after 1918 was (or was not) constrained by adherence to Socialism, and the difficult experiences of minority government. A few candidates showed detailed knowledge of how the Labour party worked and the dynamics of its relationship with trade unionism. Less successful were attempts at a chronological approach – in an exam length essay this simply overwhelmed candidates, especially as they tended to peter out in the 1930s. The best answers raised interesting points such as: could Labour have achieved any more in the inter-war years; or was the Labour party financially able to beat other parties in an age of mass democracy. Essays were enthusiastic about the question and usually argued convincingly.

Question 3. Why, given their commitment to freedom, were the Liberals unable to give women the freedom to vote? (16 answers)
Several answers questioned whether the Liberals were unable or unwilling to extend the franchise to women. This extended to questioning whether Liberals were actually committed to freedom – although these essays tended to link 'freedom' too closely and solely to this one issue. Various motives were posited for the 'unable' interpretation, including the pre-eminence of other issues.

Divisions within the Liberals were well examined in several essays, although almost none considered the influence of any other party (i.e. Labour's support for women's votes) even in passing. Candidates also knew a great deal about suffragettes and on the significance of the war in settling the franchise question. A few answers contained interesting comments about the class structure of the suffrage movement and how this influenced societal as well as constitutional claims.

Question 4. Why did the First World War produce a Conservative-dominated coalition government? (9 answers)
The majority of answers concentrated on events within the war and the drift towards a conservative 'interpretation' of the war. They also knew about the changing balance within the coalitions and the introduction of business interests after 1916. A few concentrated on events towards the end of the war and examined the justification for continued coalition government into peacetime, in which the machinations of the coupon election declined in importance. The weaker answers were simply 'decline of the Liberals' essays – about which the question did not ask.

Question 5.
EITHER: Why was the question of Irish Home Rule not settled before 1922? (3 answers)
OR: Why was the question of Northern Ireland not settled before 1997? (1 answer)
Too few answers on which to comment.

Question 6. Why was the Attlee government unable to sustain its momentum? (46 answers)
The question produced an intriguing array of interpretations of the word 'momentum'. Amongst them were the winter of 1946-7; the disputes over further nationalisation after 1948; ideological disputes by 1950-1; and, from a different direction, Labour never lost momentum but was cheated by the electoral system. A few candidates considered whether loss of momentum applied any more to Attlee's government than to others which lasted comparable periods – generally concluding that they did not. Whatever the interpretation, candidates displayed wide-ranging knowledge, often deploying it very well. Sometimes however, industrial policy seemed to exist entirely separately from social policy. Similarly although Britain's parlous financial position in 1945 was frequently referred to, the ways in which Labour's programme was funded received little attention. A common assertion was that Labour 'ran out of ideas'. A counter assertion was that Labour had inaugurated so much that its aim had become efficiency in implementation of its legislation, and that this was itself 'momentum'. Most essays contained brief mentions of the Conservatives but only bland statements that they had modernised themselves and/or had good luck with the electoral system. Nonetheless, the standard of most essays was high.

Question 7. '1951-64 saw consensus government, not Conservative government.' Discuss. (16 answers)
Virtually all candidates drew distinctions between 'consensus' and 'conservative'. Some believed that there was little difference because consensus was what most Conservative governments sought. Others took aim at the term consensus and argued that it had never existed ('merely a term of Tory propaganda' in the view of one candidate). Although several answers were quite elegantly constructed, others were simply factually thin, and, amongst other weaknesses, showed no knowledge of events from 1959-64. Such answers were therefore incapable of considering what went wrong with consensus and/or the Conservatives.

Question 8. Why was it the Conservatives who decolonized, and not Labour? (8 answers)
Few answers but often very well informed displaying knowledge of many authors and their contending arguments – whether economic and social, domestic, political, and Britain's place in the world. A few pointed out that had Labour been in office, matters would have been only marginally

different after 1957, and therefore decolonisation was as much a matter of government, rather than strictly party politics. Most essays were to a high standard.

Question 9. 'The defining characteristic of British government since 1974 has been diminishing state capacity.' Discuss. (7 answers)
Some of the answers were rather 'a stab in the dark', either because they struggled to identify what they meant by the word 'state' or because they wished for a different start date so that they could address a topic of their own choice. Most candidates disagreed with 'diminishing state capacity' and argued instead that there was an unwillingness to use the state to its full capacity.

Question 10. Were the Conservative governments of 1979-97 more about order or freedom? (41 answers)
Several answers were spirited, lively and fluent, and in a few cases provocative. Many others were well informed and clearly presented. More essays argued for order rather than freedom, although a frequent line was that order (especially economic) was necessary to promote freedom. Plenty of answers moved beyond the familiar socially authoritarian versus economic liberalism argument, finding legislation which involved both approaches simultaneously. Some answers concentrated too heavily on one side of the question while virtually ignoring the other. A few were also too attached to the term 'Thatcherism', not explaining clearly what they had in mind, and whether it survived Thatcher. This was also pertinent to the significant number of essays, which contained nothing (or virtually nothing) about Major's government, thereby not allowing a full answer to the question. Nevertheless, most essays displayed a fairly clear knowledge of events and some conveyed the sense of 'mission' amongst Conservatives in the 1980s and why that waned in the 1990s.

Question 11. Why did Labour win three full terms of office after 1997? (31 answers)
Answers covered such themes as the reorganisation of the Labour party in the 1990s, the weaknesses of the Conservatives in and after 1997, Labour's own priorities and what 'New Labour' meant in office – both theoretically and in practice. There were some analyses of the Third way, although little about whether this strand of thought remained significant. There were also a few essays, which asserted that Brown's reputation as Chancellor was overstated because economic growth after 1997 would have occurred under any set of government policies and therefore by implication a New Labour project was unnecessary to gain or regain the power. The question asked about full terms and so some material on Brown's premiership would have helped several essays, which ended rather abruptly without reference to 2007-10.

Question 12. Should a student of modern British political and governmental history have foreseen the UK's decision to leave the European Union? (9 answers)
A few answers were excellent, deploying impressive knowledge of changing patterns of scholarly work involving UK/EU relations., with conclusions of both 'yes' and 'no'. Weaker essays concentrated too much on 2014-16 and tended to a basic narrative. The weakest gave the impression of searching for a question to answer. All but the best answers showed too little knowledge of 'governmental'.

203: Theory of Politics
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Overall the standard was again reasonably high. The familiarity with, and understanding of, relevant material was generally good. The most successful candidates avoided simply deploying and explaining positions in the literature but grappled with the particular challenges posed by specific questions. The spread in answers was relatively uneven, with some of those avoided questions being precisely those where a familiar debate in the literature wasn't readily to hand. Candidates who had

the confidence to tackle those the questions which may have been perceived as more challenging in that regard were often rewarded, and those questions attracted some of the very best answers.

1. 'Whether or not free-riding is morally wrong, considerations of fairness alone cannot justify the right for the state to coerce.' Discuss.
A very popular question and a wide spread in the quality of answers. Though many of the answers demonstrated at least a reasonably good understanding of fair-play arguments, better answers were distinguished both by their precision and detail, as well their offering some reflection on the relation between the moral wrongness of free-riding and the justification of state coercion. As has often been the case with questions related to political obligation in recent years, there was an unfortunate, but familiar, tendency to try and fit a prepared answer into the framework of the question.

2. 'Neither in virtue of their universality, nor by their being grounded in our humanity, guarantees that human rights are important.' Is this a fair assessment?
Evidently, candidates found this a challenging questions and, in consequence, it attracted few answers. Those that managed to answer it successfully tended to analyse the debate between traditional and practice-based account of human rights. The weakest answers showed a near wholesale neglect of the quotation.

3. 'The state can only enhance individuals' freedom by expanding their opportunities.' Discuss.
In many cases candidates took this as a prompt inviting a general discussion as to how to conceptualise freedom. Better answers went beyond this and reflected on the relationship between the state and individuals' freedom. There were several thoughtful answers which drew on the work of Charles Taylor and Philip Pettit to challenge an opportunity-based view of freedom.

4. If democratic voting is no more fair a procedure than flipping a coin, should we conclude that democracy is justified by something other than fairness?
The differences in quality between the answers to this question were, as is often the case, correlated with the varying willingness to grapple with the puzzle posed by the question. In the instances of weaker answers, candidates rehearsed surveys of possible justifications for democracy, whereas the stronger responses considered different ways of conceiving of fairness and how much weight, if any, fairness should be given in the justification of democracy.

5. What, if anything, follows from the claim that the distribution of natural talent is arbitrary from a moral point of view?
A relatively popular question which attracted a range in the quality of answers. The question was a comparatively open one, and many candidates apparently struggled with the task of generating their own framework for an answer. For the most part answers demonstrated a good understanding of material of potential relevance for the question, however candidates were distinguished by their ability to marshal that material in service of a focused response to the question.

6. 'Tax avoidance is not illegal and therefore never unjust.' Discuss.
This question was challenging and perhaps for that reason not especially popular. In some instances of less successful answers, candidates focused on the potential injustice of taxation and used the question as a platform for discussing Nozick's entitlement theory, which, whilst not irrelevant, resulted in the neglect of tax avoidance as an element of the particular question. The best answers discussed the relationship between justice and the basic structure and considered whether citizens have obligations of justice that go beyond what just institutions require of them.

7. 'The distinction between men and women is not just of difference but of power and powerlessness.' Discuss.
The quality of answers was reasonably high overall and some of the best answers were able to integrate a general discussion concerning how to understand power with an analysis of the conceptualisation of difference between men and women.

8. Can political liberalism come to terms with disagreement about abortion?
Another question whose challenging character may have discouraged more widespread uptake. It had a rather low floor, high ceiling. The few answers it did attract were divided between those on the one hand that offered rather imprecise discussions on liberalism and controversial issues, and on the other hand a couple of excellent, knowledgeable and reflective answers.

9. 'Global inequalities are as much an affront to freedom as they are a concern of justice.' Discuss.
The fact that this question may have been perceived to traverse multiple topics could explain its relative lack of popularity. The better answers, of which there were several, thought imaginatively about ways that global inequality could be an issue of freedom and included the discussion of issues of domination and immigration restrictions.

10. Are there ways of defining political concepts that are less ideological than others?
Too few answers to comment

11. Is there anything more to conservatism than the preservation of existing value?
Although a rather unpopular question, this was answered reasonably successfully by those who attempted it. For the most part answers evidenced a good knowledge of relevant material and tended to offer balanced responses.

12. Must ideals in political theory be feasible if they are to have any worth?
Comparatively few candidates attempted this question but those that did tended to produce thoughtful and interesting responses. The best answers reflected on different ways in which an ideal might have worth.

204: Modern British Government and Politics
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

1. Have procedural reforms of the House of Commons made backbench MPs more powerful?
This was a popular question. Candidates generally showed good knowledge of the procedural reforms. Better answers also knew the literature on their effects and were aware of the methodological problems of how to measure backbench power.

2. Are the obstacles to further House of Lords reform technical or political?
This was also a very popular question. Again, most candidates knew the history of Lords reform, although some were vague about the most recent developments. The better answers attempted to use the distinction between technical and political obstacles. Some also located the problem as the British variant of a general problem of bicameralism. The weaker answers were general treatments of the intractability of the problem of Lords reform.

3. Why has it proved so much harder to devolve power within England than it was to devolve power to Scotland and Wales?
Surprisingly very few answers, perhaps a consequence of the focus on England.

4. Why has the system of devolved power-sharing government in Northern Ireland broken down?
Too few answers to comment.

5. 'The problem with the UK civil service is that the things that need reform are exactly the things that make reform difficult.' Discuss.
This question was generally well answered, but most candidates wrote in over general terms on the problems of the civil service without engaging with the question of what precisely makes reforms difficult. Here, as in the answer to Q2, it was useful to be aware of a broader literature, in this case on reforming bureaucracies.

6. Should the powers of the UK Prime Minister be codified?
Too few answers to comment.

7. What are the causes of greater volatility in UK voting behaviour?
Too few answers to comment.

8. Are UK voters swayed more by performance than policies?
This was a popular question. Almost all candidates were aware of the valence theories, although a few thought there was just one theory of valence. The best answers knew the literature well.

9. How much does ideology define the UK party system?
Too few answers to comment.

10. How should we explain the pattern of voting in the 2016 referendum on UK membership of the European Union?
Surprisingly few answers to this question.

11. Is political participation in the UK declining, or are people participating as much but in new ways?
This was a popular question, and the best answers were aware of the scholarly literature in depth. Weaker answers were too speculative, and also focused too much on party membership.

12. Does the relationship between the UK government and the media work in the public interest?
This was a popular question, and attracted some thoughtful answers. The weaker answers failed to define 'public interest' or offered crude accounts of the relationship between government and media.

205: US Government and Politics
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Question	No. of responses (PPE and HP)
1	10
2	4
3	7
4	2
5	8
6	5

7	4
8	8
9	0
10	2
11	5
12	5

Eleven of the twelve questions were attempted by at least two candidates and in general candidates do not over concentrate on particular topics, though questions on the presidency, exceptionalism, elections and the judiciary were popular. The spread of marks was good with some excellent papers scoring high firsts and few sinking below a good 2.1 standard. Overall candidates demonstrated a strong knowledge of the scholarly literature and attempted to engage questions as posed.

1. (Exceptionalism) The most popular question, yielding a wide variety in the quality of responses. Most candidates gave solid definitions of exceptionalism, but only the best responses addressed the question of temporal change.

2. (Congress) Most candidates showed a decent knowledge of the institutional differences between the House and Senate, though not all fully considered the specific tools available to the minority party in each chamber. None considered how 'influence' could be measured, and few attended to the temporal dimension of the question (the 'now').

3. (Presidency) One of the more popular questions. Most candidates adequately explained and evaluated Neustadt's original claim about the sources of presidential power, but few candidates addressed the dimension of temporal change prompted by the question.

4. (Parties) Only two candidates attempted this question. Neither demonstrated an awareness of the historical development of the main parties.

5. (Elections) Also a popular question, with varied quality of response by candidates. The best responses situated the question in the academic debate, addressed its theoretical crux (i.e., the tension between partisanship and ideology), and considered the implications. Weaker answers touched on some relevant contextual phenomena such as polarisation and the role of media.

6. (Federalism) Few candidates distinguished between state and federal interests. Nor was there much consideration of how we might know whether state-level policy outcomes are the result of federal or state pressures.

7. (Interest groups) The better answers included an awareness of the measurement difficulties, but all candidates needed to distinguish between types of interest groups more thoroughly

8. (Federal courts) The best responses complicated the dichotomy posed by the question, and also considered the complexities of the courts' legitimacy. A number of candidates defaulted to standard comparisons of different philosophies of judicial decision-making, without tying the discussion convincingly to the actual question.

9. (Constitution) No candidates attempted to answer this question.

10. (Economic policy) Two candidates responded to this question and gave strong answers, both demonstrating a solid understanding of the economic policy making apparatus (both fiscal and monetary).

11. (Race) Some solid discussion of the role of race in the US, with good knowledge of the relevant theoretical frameworks, but few candidates addressed the causal claim in the question directly.

12. (Media) Most candidates demonstrated an understanding of the mechanisms tying media to political outcomes. Not all fully addressed the political consequences of declining local news, and not all considered the decline's causal relationship with polarisation.

206: Politics in Europe
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

There were six scripts of which two were excellent, and the other five achieved a 2.1 standard. The quality of individual answers was high, with a few the best answers demonstrating excellent understanding of the theoretical arguments and using a broad range of relevant empirical examples from states across Europe.

Out of the 12 questions, seven questions attracted at least one answer, and five questions received no attempts. The detailed question breakdown is as follows:

Question	Number of Answers
1	2
2	3
3	1
4	0
5	4
6	0
7	1
8	3
9	0
10	0
11	1
12	0

Specific notes on questions with a substantial number of answers:

Q2 Three candidates answered this question. The best answers explained both the success and decline of social democratic parties, drawing on a wide range of factors and empirical examples.

Q5 This was the most popular question and was answered by four students. The best answers demonstrated an excellent knowledge of the substantial research on the subject, as well as a very good ability to critically evaluate competing arguments and evidence.
Q8 Three candidates answered this question. The best answers combined a very good understanding of theoretical arguments with an excellent ability to present and critically evaluate the results of quantitative and qualitative analyses.

207: Politics in Russia and the Former Soviet Union
The examination was taken by 12 PPE students and 2 HP students. Marks ranged from 73 to 62, with an overall average of 67. Five candidates achieved a First Class mark.

Frequency of responses: low (up to 4), high (more than 4).

1) To what extent did Gorbachev's reforms democratize the political system? (High)
The better answers combined knowledge of Gorbachev's political reforms with a critical assessment of their strengths and limitations.

2) Account for the varied forms of nationalism in the late Soviet period. (Low)
This question produced a number of first class answers. The better scripts considered the different varieties of nationalism; the factors that contributed towards differing nationalist strategies, and they engaged critically with the competing perspectives in the extant literature.

3) Assess the reasons for the "partial reform" (Hellman) of post-Soviet economies. (High)
The strongest answers defined the concept of 'partial reform'; discussed the reasons for its persistence (Soviet legacy, authoritarianism, links to the international economy etc.), and discussed the limitations of the concept.

4) What factors have shaped the governing strategies deployed by post-Soviet presidents? (Low)
The top answers discussed governing strategies such as coalitions, dominant parties and patronage networks, and considered the influence of Soviet legacies, formal powers and the availability of economic resources to presidents.

5) Are elite divisions the main drivers of electoral protest in post-Soviet societies? (High)
Many answers to this question showed good knowledge of the literature on electoral protest. However, there was persistent misrepresentation of certain cases as examples of electoral protest: Ukraine 2014, Armenia 2018. The strongest answers explained the reasons for elite-level dynamics - lame duck presidents, electoral crisis etc. – and considered alternative explanations (e.g. diffusion).

6) Do opposition parties play a significant role in post-Soviet polities? (Low)
This essay produced some excellent answers. The strongest scripts explored the importance of regime-level differences (e.g. the impact of competitive authoritarianism); considered the influence of dominant parties and elite cooptation in weakening opposition parties, and discussed the significance of voter cleavages in preserving the viability of certain opposition parties.

7) Have ruling parties become an important source of authority for post-Soviet regimes? (Low)
The better answers discussed areas in which dominant parties command authority - legislative institutions, regional government - as well as their role in electoral politics. They also considered the limitations of dominant parties in the sphere of executive politics.

8) To what extent is corruption in post-Soviet societies the result of weak executive accountability? (Low)

This question attracted few takers. The strongest scripts considered the question from the perspective of principal-agent theory and provided good examples. They also discussed the difficulty in identifying the causes of corruption.

9) How does natural resource wealth enhance the authority of post-Soviet leaders? (High)
Many students answered this question. The better scripts considered a range of areas - election cycles, rents, patronage, security, power projection overseas etc. - in which resources can benefit leaders. They also discussed the ways in which resource dependence can weaken the authority of leaders.

10) Is ethno-nationalism the main political cleavage in post-Soviet societies? (None)

11) Assess the usefulness of clan-based explanations of Central Asian politics. (None)

12) Assess the effectiveness of US and European-led democracy promotion programmes in the former Soviet Union. (None)

208: Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa
As in previous years, the students answered the examinations well and demonstrated excellent knowledge and the ability to coherently structure arguments. Of the thirty students (twenty-four PPE students and six History and Politics students) who took the exam, eleven had 1st class performances; eighteen were at 2:1 level and one at 2:2. This is very positive, and the number of excellent performances is noteworthy (six scripts at or above 73% were outstanding and showed an impressive intellectual originality). To a larger extent than in previous years, the general level was extremely high, with only a handful of disappointing scripts.

As is sometimes the case with the 208 exam, some students struggled to maintain consistency across all three essays: candidates toward the lower 2:1 end sometimes had a mark at or below the 2:2/2:1 borderline, while candidates who performed well across the exam nonetheless often had one mark below the 2:1/1st borderline, typically the last essay. As noted in previous years, this occasionally uneven performance of some candidates across the three essays is perhaps related to the complex and varied nature of the syllabus, and the broad range of empirical material that students must grasp. This said, this was significantly less the case this year than in previous years, and many scripts were consistent throughout.

A very positive aspect of this year's exam is that again all questions were again tackled by students. However, as usual, there was a high level of bunching around certain essay topics. The question on the politics of religion attracted the attention of students and resulted in capable but sometimes predictable essays. The questions on conflict and the politics of economic reform also proved popular, if less so than in the previous year. The quality of the essays on conflict continue to show improvements away from predictable "greed and grievance" analysis and it featured less commonly used and often interesting case studies. The essays on gender were consistently good. The best essays were those that somehow contested the literature, rather than those that embraced well-worn positions in the literature. Only a few students attempted the questions on agriculture, authoritarianism and social movements.

Some candidates still lost marks for failing to define key terms or to answer all parts of a question. Those candidates that did engage with key concepts and major comparative debates in the literature developed more thorough contributions and were rewarded accordingly. One of the most positive aspects of this year's paper is that students answered questions with reference to no less than thirty-five different Sub-Saharan African states (a number that has continued to increase in recent

years) and showed a strong commitment to sustained comparison. The over-concentration on one case study, and its deployment across several essays, continues to be a rare occurrence. However, Kenya, Nigeria, and Zambia were still more frequently engaged with than other cases. The Francophone states remained underrepresented but the increase in references to them reported last year, as well as knowledge of the relevant literature, continued in 2018. The Horn of Africa, which in previous years was rarely addressed, featured much more prominently across a number of questions, but is still under-represented.

The candidates could still do a better job in three areas, some of which have been flagged out in the exam reports of previous years. First, the candidates should provide a more nuanced scoping of their answer: how representative are the cases they draw on? How were the examples chosen, and how are they situated in time and space? How generalizable are the suggested conclusions? Second, candidates should make a an effort to tackle essays, especially those that lend themselves to predictable treatments, in a more deliberately original manner, both theoretically and in terms of engaging with a broader range of case-studies (this said, improvements in the essays on topics such as conflict and economic reform show that students are taking this advice to heed). Third, too many candidates picked up on one scholarly reference (say, on ethnicity or the politics of economic reform) and provided extensive paraphrases of its contents, used the same case studies, came to similar conclusions, etc., in a virtual mimicking of such contributions. This sort of over-dependence on one text does not do justice to the varied and contrasting arguments to be found across the field. While these points need to be kept in mind, the overall level of empirical and theoretical sophistication was once more commendable and this is yet again an excellent set of scripts.

209: Politics of Latin America

This paper was sat by seven PPE finalists and one HP candidate. There were two distinction marks, five in the upper second range, and one mark below 50. The mean score was a 64.

Answers were skewed toward a small number of topics: popular mobilization, executive-legislative relations, market reform, populism and the Pink Tide accounted for two thirds of the answers produced. Three questions (modes of transition, dependency theory, and conditional cash transfers) were not answered by any candidate.

Some answers seemed a bit rehearsed, e.g. the argument democratization was caused more by elite divisions than by popular mobilization, or the argument that populism is a corrective to democracy in theory but not in practice. The best answers strived for originality by weaving together explanatory variables in unexpected ways, rather than putting across a well-worn critique.

Also, the strongest performers were able to weave in good examples from the recent political history of Latin America. Although the overall performance was good, we felt that answers tended to be stronger on theory than on the empirics, and students could be encouraged to read a bit more on country cases and regional developments in order to bolster their arguments.

Question	Takers (of 8)*
1. 'Explanations of state capacity based on inter-state war account for variation in state strength across Latin America.' Discuss.	1
2. How important is the role of popular mobilization as an explanation for the post-1978 wave of democratic transitions in Latin America?	5
3. How does the mode of transition to democracy in Latin America shape the subsequent party system?	0

4. Does the executive branch consider the legislative branch when making policy in Latin America?	5
5. What accounts for differences in the extent of market reforms across Latin American countries in the 1980s and 1990s?	3
6. Can dependency theory still explain Latin America's relationship with the international system?	0
7. What explains the variation in the electoral success of the left across Latin America since 1998?	3
8. Why did some Latin American party systems fragment in the wake of the recent democratic transition, while others strengthened?	2
9. 'Latin American voters are not ideological.' Discuss.	1
10. 'Populism is a corrective for poorly functioning Latin American democracies.' Discuss.	3
11. 'The impeachment of Latin American presidents is functionally equivalent to a vote of no confidence in a parliamentary system.' Discuss.	1
12. 'Conditional Cash Transfers (CCTs) are a mechanism of clientelism.' Discuss.	0

*7 were PPE finalists with one HP candidate

Comments on Individual Questions:

Q2 (popular mobilization and democratization): Answers to this question were generally good. Most candidates compared the role of popular mobilization to other causes of democracy, and some used examples to illustrate their answers.
Q4 (interbranch relations): Students could be encouraged to consider O'Donnell's delegative democracy model, as well as possible connections with the new literature on coalitional presidentialism.
Q5 (market reforms): Answers to this question were generally very strong.
Q7 (electoral success of the left): Answers to this question could have been stronger. For example, in general the essays failed to distinguish between different types of lefts and why each one succeeds/fails.
Q8 (party systems in new democracies): The question wording itself could have been improved, given that it implies that fragmentation is the opposite of "strength." It would be more effective to ask students what "party system strength" really is, rather than hint at a definition. However, this issue did not seem to affect the essays produced.
Q10 (populism): Most answers discussed pros and cons of populism as it relates to democratic quality. Answers seemed a bit rehearsed.

211: Politics in the Middle East 2017-18
The total number of students sitting the exam this year was 31: 26 PPE and 5 HP. Last year we had 20 in total: 13 PPE and 7 HP. It is not apparent why the numbers had previously dropped so significantly, but it is useful to know that the numbers increased this year.

There were 3 Firsts awarded, so 10% of the total, which is broadly in line with the desired outcome. At the other end of the scale, there was only one Lower Second awarded.

The Upper Seconds were evenly split between marks of 60-64 and 65-69, but the average mark was 65; this is lower than last year's average which was 68. Last year's papers were of a particularly high

standard but whether this can be linked to the lower number taking the course last year is debatable.

Last year's unpopular questions were not repeated on this year's exam paper, i.e. on colonialism, and terrorism; but new questions to replace them (on sectarianism, and Islamist parties) were also not popular.

Least popular questions:

1) Similarities and differences between sectarian movements in Iraq and Syria (1 answer)
2) Do events since Arab Spring show ME states to be artificial constructs? (2 answers)
3) Discuss: Islamist parties adapt to local contexts rather than sticking to rigid ideology (4 answers)

Popular questions:

4) Concept of Arab nationalism (15 answers)
5) Durability of Arab monarchies (12 answers)
6) Success of ME oil producers in reducing oil rents (11 answers)

As the topics of sectarianism, the Arab Spring, and Islamism are all core parts of the course outline, teachers of the course need to be aware that students have found the topics troublesome and aim to cover these more thoroughly.

There is nothing to suggest that the academic staff strikes had a significant or any effect on the teaching of the course, and certainly not in the first term.

212: International Relations in the Era of Two World Wars

19 candidates attempted this paper, of whom two were from the Joint School in History and Politics, and the rest from PPE. Six candidates (32%) achieved First Class marks (70+) on the paper overall, and the rest achieved Upper Second Class marks. Overall, the standard of answers on the paper was very high. There were no short weight scripts.

The distribution of answers was as follows:

Q.	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**
Answers	15	4	3	6	1	2	5	4	1	10	5	1

The most popular questions were on the origins of the First World War (Q1) and the League of Nations (Q10): the former topic has often attracted many answers in the past, but the League has not tended to be such an attractive topic, and this perhaps was due to the fairly broad nature of the question which drew candidates' interest. The least popular questions or topics were on the 'Little Entente' in Eastern Europe (Q5), the global economic order (Q9), and the systemic consequences of World War Two (Q12). We shall offer further comments on the more frequently answered questions below.

1. Was World War One caused by rising Great Powers challenging established ones?

The quality of answers varied widely, which is perhaps not surprising given that so many candidates attempted this question. The better answers drew upon a wide range of examples, including for example Russo-Japanese relations, to think about tensions between various rising and established powers. The weaker answers tended to rely too heavily on textbook accounts of the origins of the war, with inadequate attention to the specifics of the question.

4. 'The Dawes Plan was more important than the Locarno Treaties in stabilising European politics.' Discuss.
Answers here tended to be either extremely good – at or close to First Class quality – or really rather weak, and falling into the Lower Second range. The latter tended to lack historical detail on either or both of Dawes or Locarno. In some cases, the question seems to have been treated as an invitation to discuss the general consequences of the Versailles Treaty. Better answers were much more focussed on the specifics of both the Dawes plan and the agreements made at Locarno, and showed excellent knowledge of the historiography here.

7. Was Japanese imperialism driven by economic necessity?
Candidates generally gave very solid answers to this question, all at least comfortably within the Upper Second range, and with a couple that were clearly First Class. All seemed familiar with the various causes that might be seen as having led Japan towards an imperialist foreign policy, including for example the pull from military actors rather than an intentionally directed policy of the central government.

10. Did the League of Nations' achievements in other areas outweigh its failures on collective security?
This rather broad question was very attractive to candidates, and generally speaking it was well answered, with only a couple of very shallow answers that lacked sufficient detail. This question drew several First Class answers, which drew on a very extensive range of material (such as Patricia Clavin's work on the League's economic activities) and often showed great insight in handling some of the normative dimensions implied by the question.

11. Was Winston Churchill right to call World War Two 'the unnecessary war' in the sense that it could have been avoided?
Answers here were quite varied, with a couple of very strong ones offest by one or two extremely weak ones. Perhaps understandably, answers tended to focus on appeasement, and several would have benefitted from paying more attention to Hitler's foreign policy as an important counterpart to the question.

213: International Relations in the Era of the Cold War
28 candidates (25 PPE; 2 HP; 1 withdrawn)

The numbers are consistent with the previous two years and remain strong. No particular issue arose. The general standard was high: nine candidates achieved first-class marks, and the remaining eighteen obtained 2.1s. There were no 2.2s. The best answers to all questions successfully combined analytical depth with knowledge of the relevant historiography.

The vast majority of candidates chose to answer at least one or two questions from the first section of the paper. This is unsurprising, given the structure of the paper, and in line with previous years. Among the questions on thematic and regional aspects, the most popular answers were to questions 5 (China) and 12 (the Middle East). Not a single candidate attempted question 7 or 8, which may suggest an excessive focus on Europe in the current list of topics. Only one candidate attempted question 6 (Japan).

Question-specific comments:

1. Was the Cold War inevitable?

The single most popular question. Answers were generally good, with a few outstanding ones. Most candidates were able combine insight into the origins of the Cold War with a reasoned discussion of the role of personality and individuals. Relatively few managed to provide a solid discussion of ideas and goals in the US and the USSR, which greatly improved their answers. This is a topic especially rich in historiographical depth. The best answers took advantage of it.

2. Did the adoption of 'peaceful coexistence' by the Soviet Union change the nature of the Cold War?
A fairly popular question, with generally good results. Most candidates showed good knowledge of a few of the major crises of this era. Fewer candidates were able to explain and analyse the goals of specific policies. While not as rich in literature as the previous topic, there is still a number of key texts that candidates should be familiar with. The best answers discussed them.

3. Was détente an American project?
Another relatively popular question. Most students rejected the prompt, arguing for a multi-faceted view of détente. Most candidates discussed both superpower and European détente, while fewer included analyses of crises in the Third World. The latter tended to be the most complete answers. The literature on détente is large and daunting, but the majority of candidates managed to focus on the most relevant books and articles.

4. Did Reagan end the Cold War?
The second most-popular question, and the one in which candidates did best on average. The vast majority answered the question negatively, discounting the US role in the end of the Cold War. This reflects the historiographical trend and shows that students can engage critically with it.

5. Was China primarily preoccupied with seeking security from external threats between 1949 and 1991?
A very popular question in the second section of the paper. Candidates did generally quite well, combining discussion of some of the key events with analyses of doctrine and leadership. There was no general consensus in the answers, and candidates took very different approaches in explaining the PRC's foreign policy during the Cold War. As in other cases, the very best answers showed an advanced knowledge of the key historiography.

6. Did Japan manage to have a foreign policy autonomous from the United States during the Cold War?
Too few answers for any meaningful comment.

7. Were France and Germany regional or global powers during the Cold War?
No answers.

8. 'The process of European integration could start only in the context of the Cold War.' Discuss.
No answers.

9. Did decolonization make the Cold War more or less ideological?
Relatively few answers, but of generally good quality. The best ones combined discussion of classic Cold War ideologies with political and economic ideologies that originated in the Third World.

10. What caused Soviet interventions in Eastern Europe between 1949 and 1991?
Relatively few answers, of varying quality. While some candidates constructed excellent answers, others got bogged down in long definitional discussions that added little to the overall quality. In this as in other topics, knowledge of the historical context is essential.

11. Was the Vietnam war a 'proxy war'?
Too few answers for any meaningful comment. Surprising, given the popularity of the topic.

12. To what extent did the search for oil motivate American and Soviet involvement in the Middle East during the Cold War?
Another very popular question. In general, answers were good. While relatively few managed to engage with the specificities of oil in the region, most did present a solid overview of the Middle East in the Cold War that referred to energy policy. Given the richness and depth of the existing literature, it is surprising that only relatively few candidates engaged extensively with the historiography.

214: International Relations
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

The IR core paper remains very popular with Honours students. The overall standard was very commendable, with some excellent answers at the top end, and only a relatively small number of answers below 2.1 standard. The best answers focused tightly on the question, and combined empirical breadth with theoretical sophistication, and engagement with the relevant conceptual frameworks. The ability to relate the material learnt to contemporary issues (Brexit, Trump, Russia, the refugee crisis etc.) was also an advantage.

Comments on specific questions:

1. (norms): not many takers for this question, but the answers were generally competent; few candidates offered any alternatives to the proposition in the question.
2. (globalisation): a popular question, with some predictable answers; evidence for increased "western domination" was sometimes asserted rather than demonstrated.
3. (trade): not a very popular question, but the answers were generally of a good standard, with sound knowledge of recent institutional trends.
4. (the UN): a popular question, with some very strong, detailed answers at the top end, exploring the different international roles of the UN (especially peacekeeping), as well as the role of agencies.
5. (nationalism): good answers, with a decent range of examples, although not always very sophisticated conceptually.
6. (NATO): a fairly popular question, generally well-answered; the best answers also discussed the impact of Trump.
7. (democracy and war): a popular question, with many predictable answers using the question as a peg to rehearse the strengths and weaknesses of Democratic Peace Theory; the best answers actually focused on the question.
8. (sub-state actors): not many takers for this question, but the answers were generally of a decent standard.
9. (power): not many takers, but some of the answers were very strong and examined the concept of power from a variety of perspectives.
10. (Huntington): a popular question, and the answers were generally of high quality, combining conceptual critique with a range of examples.
11. (distributive justice): a limited number of answers for this question, but they were generally of good quality, although there is an unfortunate tendency to treat this question purely in philosophical terms.
12. (post-Cold War conflicts): some very good answers, taking on board relevant literatures (e.g. on "new wars") and coming up with interesting generalisations about the state of the post-Cold war world.

215: Political Thought: Plato to Rousseau
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Overall, this year's answers were of a decent standard, with some examples demonstrating a high level of historical understanding and a close and individualised reading of the core texts. The better answers offered a clear line of argumentation running throughout, avoided sweeping generalisations and provided a critical reading of secondary material, as opposed to simply restating the main arguments. The very best answers were able to relate the passage or topic directly addressed by the question with a broader understanding and contextualisation of an author's thinking to themes running throughout the paper, or put one thinker 'in conversation' with others. One major disappointment, however, was the continued lack of engagement with the works of Aquinas and Montesquieu (no responses to either question). This is a pity because both, of course, are either engaging with or have clear influences on the thinking of many of the authors with whom the students are seemingly more familiar. Thomas More only came up in one of the thematic/comparative questions, and there is a case to be made for adding a direct question on his thought. The clustered nature of the candidates' selections indicate that many students approach the exam by picking three authors, as opposed to focusing on arguments and authors across the paper. This is an issue to consider. Finally, when compared to recent years, it was not apparent that the two cancelled lectures (due to strike action) had any bearing on the topics chosen or the quality of the responses.

1. Justice is "that each one must practice one of the functions in the city [Polis], that one for which his nature made him naturally most fit" (Republic, 433a). What are the implications of this claim for Plato's view of the ideal constitution [Politeia]?
This was a popular question. Most candidates demonstrated a good understanding of the centrality of the defence of justice in the Republic, often linking the discussion in Book I to Socrates' subsequent discussion of the Kallipolis. This said, some responses only vaguely referred to themes in the text, and many answers were light on textual references and analysis. Some of the strongest answers related the defence of justice to Plato's wider epistemology and to a broader discussion of the practice of philosophy and the political skill (technē) of the philosopher as statesman.

2. "A citizen is distinguished from all others by his participation in giving judgement and holding office" (Politics, Book III, Chapter I). But Aristotle thinks certain ways of living preclude some from participating. Why?
There were, somewhat surprisingly, few answers to this question. Many of the responses referred to the debate over slavery, though in doing so often demonstrated a better use of secondary sources than a close, and perhaps more nuanced, reading of Book I. Better answers linked public life – and those engaged in it – with Aristotle's discussion on desires and the development of human character through habituation and education.

3. Does Aquinas reconcile the demands of human virtue with Christian salvation?
There were no responses to this question.

4. "I love my native city, more than my own soul" (Machiavelli: Letter to Francesco Vettori, 1527). How might this help us interpret Machiavelli's political theory?
This was a very popular question. The better answers were able to compare aspects of The Prince with The Discourses, and the best spent time putting Machiavelli in conversation with ancient thinkers (but, alas, not Aquinas). Weaker answers mostly ignored the concept of the soul in relation to Machiavelli's thought, and usually retreated to general arguments about either 'realism' or 'republicanism'.

5. Is Hobbes a utopian?
There were a number of answers to this question, with much variation. Many responses focused on whether Hobbes' intended to be utopian. The better answers spent considerable time on the concept of 'utopian' itself, its possible meanings and uses, before relating it to the Leviathan. The better responses also discussed Hobbes' scientific view of man before then going on to discuss his views on the state; while the weakest seemed to think the main arguments in Leviathan only begin at Chapter Thirteen. There was hardly any engagement with Hobbes' views on religion.

6. To what extent, if any, are the people sovereign in Locke's political theory?
There were only a few responses to this question. The better answers took a more critical eye as to whether Locke, in fact, has a conception of sovereignty – or at least went beyond a general discussion of social contract theory. The best answers spend considerable time discussing the right to resistance and Locke's discussion on prerogative.

7. 'Montesquieu's Spirit of the Laws can be characterised as a theory of political moderation.' Discuss.
There were no responses to this question.

8. To what degree is Hume's moral scepticism central to his political theory?
There were too few responses to this question, but all were of a good standard. It is worth noting that it was apparent that responses reflected a greater degree of familiarity with material covered in philosophy papers.

9. "He had nothing new, but he set everything on fire." Do you agree with Madame de Staël's characterisation of Rousseau's thought? Why or why not?
This was a popular question that produced a variety of responses. The better answers engaged with the Republican tradition or interpreted Rousseau's Social Contract, first and foremost, as a treatise on legitimacy. The weaker answers made banal points about revolution.

10. Is civic virtue more important than institutional design for political stability? Discuss with reference to TWO of the authors you have studied for this paper.
This was a relatively popular question. Most of the responses clustered around analysis of Plato, Aristotle, Hobbes and Rousseau, and related one 'ancient' to one 'modern'. The best responses spent more time unpacking the concept of institution, as something beyond simply the state.

11. To what extent is appetite, as opposed to reason, an important component to theorising the best regime? Discuss with reference to TWO of the authors you have studied for this paper.
There were too few answers to comment on.

12. To what extent should political theory base arguments on the use of historical examples? Discuss with reference to TWO of the authors you have studied for this paper.
There were too few answers to comment on.

216: Political Thought: Bentham to Weber
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Overall the scripts this year were of a good standard. Some were excellent, though none stood out as exceptional. There were no high first class marks. Examiners were pleased that a good range of questions were answered. Candidates are reminded that examiners look out for signs that they have engaged closely with the arguments of the set texts, and not just relied on secondary sources or lectures. Candidates are also reminded that examiners know that some of these authors are on the

Prelims 'Introduction to the Theory of Politics' paper. To perform at a 2.1 standard on this paper, answers should be significantly more sophisticated, both analytically and historically, than those offered at Prelims. Finally, candidates are reminded that this is a paper in the *history* of political thought. They are expected to have more than a passing knowledge of the historical circumstances of a text's publication, and to have thought about the relationship between text and context. It is notable that when compared to recent years, the strike action seemed to have no effect on the quality of responses.

Q 1. Why was Saint Simon so preoccupied with industry?
This question did not have many responses, but the most successful were those that built a case about the development of Saint Simon's thought on this issue, and showed a strong grasp of a variety of his texts and their contents.

Q 2. Why, for Bentham, did utility provide a better ground for thinking about politics than natural rights?
Again, there only a couple of responses to this question. Candidates are reminded of the importance of offering an answer to the question asked, and not just a series of good close analysis of text.

Q 3. Why, for Hegel, was it important to distinguish the state from civil society?
This was amongst the most popular questions answered. Some answers would have benefited from a simple, clear statement of the candidate's understanding of the central concepts under scrutiny, before launching into their argument in response to the question.

Q 4. Did Marx have a theory of the state?
Another popular question. Some candidates were tripped up by the difference between a *description* of the state and a *theory* of the state. Some answers, too, seemed to try to smuggle in essays about Marx on revolution into this answer: candidates are reminded to answer the question at hand, and not a previous question they might have answered for a tutorial essay.

Q 5. 'Tocqueville is a theorist not of democracy but of its demise'. Discuss.
There were some good answers to this question. The very best took seriously the request to 'discuss' the claim at hand, and were thoughtful about the different ways of interpreting it, and the different passages in Tocqueville's text that might lend support for those interpretations. Again, candidates who had read the book closely and showed as much did the best on this question.

Q 6. Is Mill best understood as a theorist of democracy?
There were several answers to this question, of varying quality. The best scrutinised what Mill might have - and indeed could have - meant about democracy, and thought carefully about whether some of his claims made it impossible for him to be considered a 'democratic' theorist.

Q 7. What, for Weber, made a political leader responsible?
This question required knowledge of Weber's 'The Profession and Vocation of Politics'. Candidates who did not have such a knowledge struggled to answer it well.

Q 8. What, for Durkheim, were social facts and what implications did their discovery hold for an analysis of social and political life?
This was a tough question and on the whole the candidates who took it on excelled.

Q 9. What role did religion play in the political thought of at least TWO of your prescribed authors?

Answers to this question were solid on the whole, though candidates are reminded that sweeping historical claims about what people in the past believed should be deployed with caution.

Q 10. Were nineteenth century thinkers more interested in theorising individualism or society? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.
This was only answered twice, but both responses were thoughtful and showed a wide range of reading.

Q 11. What, if anything, was novel about nineteenth century social science? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.
There were no answers to this question.

Q 12. Why, for nineteenth century thinkers, would someone thinking about politics look to the family? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.
There were no answers to this question.

217: Marx and Marxism
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

The paper was generally well done by candidates who frequently showed good knowledge and understanding of relevant texts and were often able to apply this effectively to the specific questions asked.

1. Does Marx have any significant non-methodological debts to Hegel?
There were too few answers to comment.

2. 'Marx's critique of utopian socialism is inaccurate and unconvincing.' Discuss.
This was a popular question. Better answers distinguished between different levels of critique of the utopian socialists and related knowledge to the key terms of the question ('inaccurate', 'unconvincing') in careful, well-defined ways.

3. 'Marx's theory of history is refuted by the facts of the historical record.' Discuss.
This was a very popular question. Candidates showed good knowledge of Marx's theory of history. Better answers also showed an ability to think about what the criteria or standards of refutation might be (and applied them).

4. Is Marx's claim that profit rests on exploitation flawed by reliance on the labour theory of value?
Candidates answered the question reasonably well, but did not always show in-depth knowledge and understanding of the labour theory of value as a theory of price formation.

5. "Only under the second Bonaparte [Louis Napoleon] does the state seem to have made itself completely independent" (Marx, 18th Brumaire). Does Marx offer an adequate account of the degree and nature of the state's 'independence' from social classes?
There were some good answers showing knowledge of relevant texts by Marx and Engels and positions in the secondary literature. Key to a very good answer was identifying criteria of independence and reflecting on the implications of the fact that, in the given quote, Marx says the state 'seems' independent.

6. Is the concept of alienation more helpful than that of injustice in understanding Marx's advocacy of communism?

There were some very good answers to this question, managing to show knowledge and understanding of both the 'Marx and justice controversy' and the literature on Marx and alienation. Many defended the importance of both concepts while also arguing for the greater importance of one or other of the concepts.

7. Does Marx adequately explain how classes form as collective actors?
There were too few answers to comment.

8. According to Marx, can a society ever be beyond 'ideology'?
Better answers analysed Marx's understanding of ideology in depth and were able to give very well structured answers to the question based on excellent textual knowledge.

9. 'A superficial attempt to convert Marxism into liberalism.' Discuss this comment on the 'Revisionism' of Eduard Bernstein.
There were too few answers to comment.

10. What sort of political institutions are necessary for the 'dictatorship of the proletariat'? Discuss with reference to the work of TWO OR MORE of the authors you have studied for this paper.
There were too few answers to comment.

11. 'Marxism offered no grounds for supporting a socialist revolution in Russia in the early twentieth-century.' Discuss with reference to TWO OR MORE of the authors you have studied for this paper.
Candidates did not show sufficient knowledge and understanding of key relevant texts and authors.

12. What implications does Gramsci's theory of hegemony have for the nature of the revolutionary party?
Candidates answering this question tended to show good knowledge and understanding of the theory of hegemony but were not always effective in relating this concretely to Gramsci's thinking about the nature of the revolutionary party.

218: Sociological Theory
3 candidates (all from PPE)

It is disappointing that only three candidates took this paper. The quality of scripts ranged from good (second class, upper division) to excellent (first class). There were two answers to Q4 (on trust) and Q5 (on social norms). There were solitary answers to Q1 (society as a system), Q2 (gender differences), Q6 (Oxford students overrepresented in the elite), Q8 (state and mafia), and Q12 (irrational beliefs).

219: Sociology of Post-Industrial Societies
There were twelve PPE candidates sitting this paper (plus one History and Politics). The distribution across classes was: two first class, nine upper second and one lower second. There were 12 questions on the paper and all but three were attempted by at least one candidate.

The general standard of performance was high. Almost all answers contained relevant material framed within an argument that could reasonably be taken to answer the question. In fact the uniformity of the answers was such that it was actually quite difficult to distinguish between them. From the evidence of the examination I would conclude that all the candidates have been well taught, perhaps even drilled with an eye on the examination. What was missing from the good but not outstanding papers was a suggestion of familiarity with arguments or evidence not drawn exclusively from the tutorial reading list. Failing that, which some might find unreasonable, I would

have liked to see more familiar and pedestrian material combined in a way that suggests some novelty. Nevertheless these scripts were, taken as a whole, the strongest I've seen for a few years.

220: Political Sociology
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Answers this year were rather mixed. While some candidates had extremely impressive knowledge of the literature on the reading list and so could construct well-informed and thoughtful answers, other candidates often missed key issues or relevant research findings. As usual, answers were usually better if they were based on a better knowledge and understanding of the literature. As well as both breadth and depth of knowledge, an appreciation of the key gaps, puzzles and debates in the literature is also extremely valuable. There were few questions where there were specific issues to point out, but they are as follows.

2. 'Class voting is now more about identity politics than economic interests.' Discuss.
Many candidates were unclear about what they understood by the term 'identity politics'. The best answers considered both class identity and the ways in which different social classes have differing views on issues where other identities matter, such as gender or ethnicity, and so how the voting behaviour of different classes can depend on non-economic, perhaps cultural, differences between classes.

6. Are religious voters 'values voters'?
Many candidates assumed that religious voters are values voters if more religious people have different values from more secular citizens and if values are correlated with vote choice. However most failed to consider the argument that even if values explain religiosity based differences in vote choice, that does not, in itself, mean that religious people vote on the basis of their values while others do not.

7. In what ways do politicians shape social attitudes?
This question required people to know the research that makes direct claims about the influence of politicians, but also consider whether other theories leave space for politicians to affect attitudes or imply that politicians have little or no role.

223: Government and Politics of Japan
There was one excellent paper but the other five were all in the 2.1 range with one just on the 2.1 boundary. As last year that were many questions unanswered which is I think a result of them creating their own revision group.

224: Social Policy
24 Candidates (23 PPE; 1 HP)

There were slightly more candidates taking the examination this year compared with last year. The scripts were of a good standard, with the spread of marks that might be expected. The most popular questions were:
• Q6 (To what extent does including gender in welfare state analysis mean that the traditional welfare regimes are irrelevant?)
• Q10 (To what extent have recent changes in the welfare mix in the UK resulted in differences in the nature of welfare provision?)
• Q11 (Is individual choice a meaningful concept in schools' policy in the UK today?)

These represented the bulk of the questions attempted, although all questions were attempted by at least one student. The three questions above represent two topics from the compulsory weeks (welfare regimes and the mixed economy of welfare) and one option topic (education). The answer to Q11 generally attracted more detailed answers, the majority of which drew upon an impressive range of empirical examples. The quality of responses for Q6 and Q10 varied more.

Many of the scripts demonstrated a very good knowledge of the subject material. A large number of students were also able to engage well with the scholarly literature, demonstrating awareness of both theoretical and empirical issues. This enabled students to sharpen their analysis by situating it within broader academic debates. The course generally takes 'recent' to mean from the Thatcher government of 1979 onwards, and the majority of students adopted this time frame. Where this was not adopted, students gave their reasoning as to why, and 'recent' was always taken to be a date later than 1979 (usually the election of the coalition government).

The weaker answers (relatively speaking) remained at the level of generalities and were lacking in detail. There were a few occasions where students' answers were not as relevant to the question as they could have been. Some students were able to draw upon very recent developments (e.g. the recent 'Welfare Conditionality' project, which was completed and released its findings in June 2018). Some students were also able to draw upon their knowledge of other subjects. Where this was done well, it allowed for incisive and sophisticated analysis. However, there were some occasions when knowledge from other subjects was drawn upon to compensate for an apparent lack of specific knowledge of the question being answered. In these scenarios, candidates could only address very general elements of the question.

On the whole, the questions worked well in terms of testing students' subject knowledge. There was little misunderstanding or misinterpretation of questions and, where appropriate, students were able to interpret the question in order to provide a relevant answer.

The number of takers for each question was as follows:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1	3	1	1	8	12	5	4	5	11	16	5

225: Comparative Demographic Systems
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Overall: a consistently very strong performance on computational questions, and (with a single exception) strong 2.1 level essays. The former pulled most candidates up to 1st class marks for the paper as a whole. The essays were strong on argument, and with good structure and narrative line, but were sometimes decidedly cavalier on evidence needed to support and develop arguments. Thus, the crucial role of population heterogeneity and its causes for understanding and interpreting population trends and process was well understood, but candidates were in several cases unable to give appropriate examples, and that limited their critical leverage.

227: Politics in China
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Sixteen finalists sat the exam in 2018. There was a fairly good spread of answers this year with takers for every one of the questions on the paper. The most popular were questions on the 1989 Tiananmen crackdown, on the success of Special Economic Zones (SEZs), on the relative success of market reform in the countryside, on whether the internet presented a challenge to the CCP regime, and on the NPC as a "rubber stamp body." This was a somewhat surprising but also welcome

development, because, with the exception of the questions on the 1989 crackdown and on the internet, these were relatively new questions on the paper. Economic and social issues arising from contemporary Chinese political development were well-covered in several essays to various questions, although, as always, candidates needed to be wary of not answering a "standard" answer on the wider topic without thinking about the precise question asked. We had a truly outstanding essay to the question on whether Xi Jinping could be considered "the new Mao" (a question to which only the one candidate responded), and another on whether China's rise is best understood in regional, or global, terms. High firsts given for answers to questions on the success of the SEZs, and China's rise as a global or regional phenomenon, which was encouraging to see, as candidates choosing these "new" questions were perhaps stepping a bit outside of their comfort zones; but we also had several high firsts given for the questions on the internet, the chief impact of the Mao era, and the success of rural reform. There were also good answers on the legacy of the Tiananmen Square protests, and, a bit unusually, no answers on the NPC as a "rubber stamp" body (somewhat surprisingly, given the growing importance of the literature on legislatures in authoritarian regimes in comparative government). There was considerably less engagement with the question on social stability, which may well be a by-product of the ramped up repression of popular contention under Xi Jinping, but also less engagement with the question regarding the viability of the "one country two systems" model for resolving tensions across the Taiwan Straits– which is surprising given the rising tensions in the South China Sea over the course of Tsai Ing-wen's tenure as the President of Taiwan. A record eleven candidates received a "first" on at least one essay question this year. Thus, overall, this was an extraordinary year of record high marks, the best of which demonstrated not only careful reading and detailed answers to the major topics covered, but also an ability to critically engage with the assigned reading in a manner, both comprehensively and creatively.

228: Politics of the EU

Only twelve students took this paper in 2018, three HP and 9 PPE students. The quality of scripts, while generally satisfactory, was seldom excellent. Some were rather thin on evidence or showed limited range in addressing the question. Final marks ranged between 60 and 71. Questions focussing on institutional, if not technical aspects of EU politics were most popular, while questions focussing on broader political issues were usually ignored.

This year we had de facto fifteen (and not just twelve) questions because the exam was taken by students from two different years with slightly different reading lists. To make sure that students were not disadvantaged by the change in the syllabus three questions were in the form "either or."

Nearly all students (ten out of twelve) addressed question 10: *What institutional reforms would mitigate the democratic deficit in the EU?* Question 2B represented another popular question: *What is the role of the EJC (European Court of Justice) in the process of judicialisation of politics in Europe?* (Seven students addressed this question). Questions 3, 4, and 6 were totally ignored. This suggests that students prepare to the exam reading chiefly textbooks and discount more sophisticated literature on the evolving nature of the EU. It should be added that very few students followed lectures for this paper. These lectures focused not only on basic institutional arrangements, but also on broader political questions, which were poorly reflected in the examined scripts.

229: Advanced paper in Theories of Justice

The paper was taken by 26 PPE students and 2 History and Politics students. The general quality of answers was very good: answers were typically sophisticated and well argued, demonstrated good understanding of the literature, and showed evidence of wide reading in the field. A small number of scripts did seem overly reliant on material from the lecture handouts. 9 papers received marks of 70

or over, 16 fell between 60 and 69, and 3 between 50 and 59. The most popular questions were (2), on whether there is a human right to free movement across state borders (16 answers), (3), on the allocation to states of the costs of climate change (17 answers), and (8), on whether disability is best understood in terms of biological or social causation (14 answers). There were also multiple takers for question (1) on international trade (6 answers), (4) on the non-identity problem (9 answers), (6) on corrective justice (8 answers), and (7) on benefiting from injustice (10 answers). Strikingly, while there was therefore otherwise a good spread of answers across the topics, the two questions on children were not popular: question (10) on the moral duties of parents and teachers attracted only 2 answers, and (11) on age and voting just one.

297: Special Subject Paper in Politics: Comparative Political Economy
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

18 students wrote the CPE 297 Special Subject: Comparative Political Economy exam. Overall, the scripts were of a very high quality, showing a thoughtful and critical engagement with the questions, as well as demonstrating strong knowledge of the material. The most popular questions related to the equity and efficiency tradeoff, varieties of capitalism, globalization and inequality. Weaker answers tended to show only cursory knowledge of the material. In some cases, candidates spent too long setting up the answer and too little providing clear evidence. In other cases, the scripts showed little evidence of extensive reading. Better answers had a clear and precise analytic set up, which outlined to the reader how the candidate would answer the question, set out clear evidence from the course materials, and provided a critical and careful evaluation of the evidence. The best answers went `under the hood' of the reading, and really discussed the quality of evidence and its applicability to the question. These answers also engaged with a wide breadth of material. Overall, the quality of answers was relatively even across questions.

297: Special Subject Paper in Politics: International Security and Conflict
For the number of candidates from PPE and HP taking this paper, see section 4.a above.

Answers were generally of a high standard, with numerous first-class awards and only one 2.2 grade. No special issues arose regarding the examination, barring a correction to question 1 (where 'principal' had been wrongly spelled 'principle)'. A total of 43 complete scripts were submitted for the 2018 examination, an increase of 11 on last year, indicating the continuing high popularity of this option. Comments on individual questions below (number of answers for each question in brackets).

1. To what extent is state weakness the principal source of insecurity in world politics? (6)
One of the most poorly answered questions, with several 2.2 marks – candidates struggled to bring relevant empirical material from the other topics of the course in to support their answers, which consequently tended towards rather vague 'to some extent state weakness is a source of insecurity' style answers. Candidates needed to more systematically compare forms of insecurity which might be thought to be associated with strong states – such as genocide/mass killing or interstate warfare – with forms typically linked to state weakness – such as transnational organized crime, terrorism, or civil war, although these categories could also be problematised. Greater consideration of what constituted state weakness would also have benefited many answers.

2. Are interstate wars always rooted in misperceptions? (10)
A relatively popular question, with answers rather divided between a number of high quality first class essays and answers that struggled to move above low 2.1 in quality. Better answers generally displayed a much more solid understanding of influential scholarly approaches such as Jervis' work on misperception or Johnson's work on overconfidence, and the links between such theories and more rationalist perspectives (Fearon, Waltz etc.). The very best answers were able to clarify with

some sophistication how wars might be thought to occur without any misperceptions involved. Some greater discussion of what really constituted misperception could have benefited a few answers, even in this stronger group. Weaker answers typically struggled to see the contrast between theories which stress misperceptions and those which do not, and consequently were often limited to rather basic lists of ways in which misperceptions could contribute to the likelihood of war, though were still usually able to identify such links in ways that showed some understanding of contemporary research.

3. Should we expect a decline of regional security organizations? (3)
Only three answers but of generally high quality, showing a strong use of empirical examples from real world cases, some good use of the literature on regional security complexes, and some effective discussion of whether security problems are now more regionalised or globalised.

4. Is there anything distinctive about 'ethnic' civil wars? (13)
As last year, a popular topic, and answers were generally of a high standard. Typically, this reflected a) candidates' strong command of the relevant scholarly literature and capacity to compare and contrast the arguments of scholars such as Kalyvas, Kaufman, Mueller, Collier & Hoeffler etc., b) candidates' capacity to talk with some sophistication about questions of identity in conflict, and c) the strong empirical references to major case studies in most answers (although the Former Yugoslavia and Rwanda were rather dominant influences). Weaker answer struggled to do more that repeat key claims arguments from the literature rather than theoretically comparing and analysing them, and were typically empirically narrower.

5. Are weapons of mass destruction useful deterrents in the twenty-first century? (5)
Not one of the more popular questions, and answers were almost uniformly of low to middling 2.1 standard. Many candidates did not display a particularly firm understanding of deterrence and consequently offered relatively shallow arguments as to whether WMDs could effectively deter different kinds of threat – mainly candidates listed some obvious cases (terrorism, transnational organized crime) where WMDs fairly clearly could not deter, rather than focusing on harder and more conventional cases like interstate conflict. Reference to the literature on the normative taboo on WMDs strengthened a few answers, but needed more linkage to strategic arguments about deterrence.

6. Can terrorists be defeated without the use of military force? (17)
A popular question, with most answers receiving high 2.1 to low first-class marks. In general, candidates showed a good understanding of contemporary research on terrorism and were able to focus with some sophistication both on whether terrorism was a rationally chosen strategy and what underlying social causes fuelled terrorism and radicalization. Correspondingly, answers were typically effective at demonstrating the main shortcomings of military strategies and the need for broader political and social strategies to combat terrorism, but were weaker at effectively identifying/reconstructing arguments for why military force might remain necessary in some cases (even if candidates then wanted to critique and reject that argument). First class marks were usually an exception to this pattern, and some made strong and empirically illustrated distinctions between different kinds of terrorist groups and the circumstances in which military force might appear more or less advisable.

7. In what ways does genocide differ from other forms of organized violence against civilians? (14)
A popular answer which generally yielded high quality answers and a few of the strongest answers in the paper. Candidates generally showed a strong understanding of the literature on genocide and mass killing and many made useful links to research on violence against civilians in civil wars too. Answers generally showed a fairly sophisticated but sometimes slightly narrow understanding of the

key conceptual features of genocide (with considerable reliance on Straus' recent work), and several answers would have benefited from showing somewhat broader understanding of competing conceptualisations. But most answers complemented this with a rather broader and deeper consideration of empirical research on genocide, and why genocides might have distinct causes and dynamics. Weaker answers often focused too exclusively on genocide to the neglect of other forms of violence against civilians, failing to establish truly distinctive features of genocide, and lacked conceptual analysis.

8. Are refugees just an outcome of domestic conflict, or also a cause of it? (18)
The most popular question this year, and answers were generally of a high quality with a large number of first class marks. Many candidates showed excellent understanding of both qualitative and quantitative empirical research on the links between refugees and conflict, considered causal links in both directions implied by the question, and correctly focused down onto domestic (rather than all) conflict. Many answers showed excellent, nuanced understanding of the different causal mechanisms involved and the relative evidence for them, while also being able to make reference to a broad range of empirical examples. Weaker answers tended to remain stuck with lists of general ways in which refugee flows were destabilising or could provoke further violence, and were too abstract/unsupported by empirical examples, though still tended to show a competent understanding of the key findings of recent research.

9. Should all gender-based violence be securitized? (14)
A much more popular topic this year than last, with four times the number of responses. The vast majority of answers were solid 2.1 efforts which displayed some good understanding of contemporary research on gender-based violence and an effective conceptual understanding of the Copenhagen School's concept of securitization. Most candidates struggled, however, to consider the benefits and problems of securitization in depth, and consequently answers tended to take the form of fairly one-sided empirical accounts of the extent of gender-based violence and its centrality to conflict. The one or two best answers did a much better job of appreciating why securitization might be counterproductive and then either siding with this conclusion or offering a sustained explanation of why it should be rejected.

10. 'The continuing exclusion of organized criminal violence from the literature on political violence is neither empirically nor theoretically justified.' Discuss. (3)
Only three answers, and all roughly mid 2.1 in quality – too small a basis to infer much.

11. Are there good grounds for thinking that cyberwar will be a significant form of conflict in future interstate relations? (16)
From the least popular question last year to amongst the most this year, with answers generally of a very high standard, with the considerable majority in the upper 2.1 or first-class bands. The best answers showed excellent understanding of the contentions of leading scholars working on cyberconflict and the underlying reason for different assessments of its likely prevalence, as well as some extremely detailed and wide-ranging knowledge of major cases/examples. Many candidates show good appreciation of the distinct dynamics between cyberwar by state actors and forms of cyber insecurity resulting from non-state actors, as well as the fluidity between these forms. Weaker answers – though there were not many – lacked really detailed theoretical discussion and empirical support – instead merely lining up the arguments of those scholars who emphasise future cyberwar against those who downplay it.

12. When, if ever, is it a bad idea to deploy peacekeepers? (10)
Answers ranged in quality from mid-2.1 to low first, and generally showed good understanding of the empirical literature, including awareness of both key case studies and broad statistical findings.

Most answers made a strong and relatively detailed defence of the value of peacekeepers in most circumstances. Though there were few seriously problematic answers, weaker efforts tended to remain overly general and lacked deep insight into the conditions under which peacekeepers could be counterproductive – instead identifying fairly basic and uncontroversial things needed for peacekeepers to work.